

QA/SDET Goals - 2025

Overview

The **QA/SDET Goals** are designed to align with **organizational priorities, automation best practices, and quality assurance objectives**. These goals focus on **delivering high-quality software, optimizing automation strategies, improving operational efficiencies, and fostering professional growth**.

This document outlines **key goals, objectives, and expected outcomes for 2025** to ensure **scalable, secure, and efficient testing processes** across teams.

Mission Statement

Ensure **quality-first software releases** by leveraging test automation to:

- Increase effectiveness** of testing processes
- Enhance efficiency** across development cycles
- Improve system performance and maintainability**
- Accelerate time-to-market** with robust software releases

As **leaders in QA automation**, our focus is to **empower teams** to deliver **high-quality solutions** that meet customer expectations. This will be accomplished through:

- **Expanding test automation coverage** to enhance software reliability
 - **Ensuring maintainability of automation frameworks**
 - **Improving data setup and reliability**
 - **Increasing performance testing efforts** to validate system scalability
 - **Building onboarding & training processes** for new SDETs
 - **Fostering collaboration with QA & Software Engineering teams**
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Goal 1: Organizational Goals – Associate Experience & Collaboration

Drive **personal performance** by actively contributing to the **organization's noble purpose, business strategy, and core values**.
Foster a **collaborative and inclusive** work environment within Scrum teams.
Promote a **culture of quality & automation-first** across all development processes.

Diversity & Inclusion

Actively participate in **Ascensus' Diversity & Inclusion initiatives**.
Engage in **learning courses** and foster **inclusive team dynamics**.

Key Objectives/Outcomes

Complete Quarterly Check-ins & Weekly Timesheets to ensure **business alignment**.
Participate in company training and apply inclusive workplace practices.
Engage in Scrum Team ceremonies (Sprint Planning, Stand-ups, Retrospectives).
Encourage cross-team knowledge sharing and **mentor new team members**.
Accurately log project-related work in Splunk for effective capitalization tracking.

Goal 2: Quality Delivery for Ascensus GS Roadmap

Delivering High-Quality, Secure, and Scalable Solutions

Support and **deliver on Ascensus GS key initiatives**, ensuring **test strategies align with business goals**.
Execute a **robust test automation strategy** to enhance **scalability, security, and performance validation**.

Key Objectives/Outcomes

Achieve 70%+ automated test coverage for regression, API, and UI testing.
Ensure all initiatives meet the Definition of Done (DoD).
Improve Security Testing by addressing vulnerabilities (SAST/DAST).
Utilize the Test Pyramid framework to optimize automation layers (Unit, API, UI, Performance).
Actively participate in road mapping sessions and contribute to technical planning.
Deliver key projects with high-quality assurance:

- GS Platform Enhancements
- Performance Testing for Scalability Validation
- API Contract Testing for Service Reliability
- Data & Infrastructure Migration Projects

Goal 3: Operational Efficiencies – Optimizing IT Throughput

Automation & AI Integration for Increased Efficiency

Leverage AI-driven testing (GitHub Copilot, Hatica) to improve efficiency, optimize execution, and reduce manual intervention.
Enhance collaboration between QA, DevOps, and Software Engineering teams to foster a quality-first mindset.

Key Objectives/Outcomes

Increase automation adoption in CI/CD by integrating tests into Jenkins/Azure DevOps.
Improve test case management by tagging regression suites in GitLab.
Conduct performance testing before deployment to ensure system scalability.
Optimize Test Data Management (TDMs) strategies for better test reliability.
Ensure security compliance by prioritizing and closing identified risks.
Enhance team efficiency metrics by tracking velocity, cycle time, and bug resolution.
Develop AI-assisted test automation strategies for improved accuracy and test creation.

Goal 4: Associate Learning & Innovation

Continuous Learning & Professional Growth

Expand technical and domain expertise through structured learning & upskilling initiatives.
Research and evaluate emerging automation frameworks, tools, and AI-driven testing approaches.
Actively contribute to knowledge-sharing initiatives across teams.

Key Objectives/Outcomes

Complete at least 3 learning initiatives, including:

- Security Training (Secure Developer Coding Course)
- Technical Skills Enhancement (AI, Automation, Performance Testing, etc.)
- Performance Testing (Blazemeter, JMeter)
- Data Testing (Informatica Testing)
- Professional Development (Leadership, Communication, Soft Skills)

Attend & present in SDET knowledge-sharing forums (Lunch & Learn, Quality Connect).
Complete industry-recognized certifications (ISTQB, AWS, etc.).
Mentor junior SDETs and help onboard new automation engineers.
Implement at least one AI/automation innovation initiative to improve test efficiency.

Goal 5: Communication & Adoption of Best Practices

Ensure QA/SDET best practices are well-documented, understood, and adopted across teams.
Improve knowledge-sharing and collaboration through structured engagement sessions.

Key Initiatives & Action Plan

SDET Connect (Weekly Principal SDET Meetings)

- Review **SDET action items & blockers**.
- Discuss **new automation initiatives** & continuous improvements.
- Evaluate **new testing tools, techniques & process optimizations**.

SDET Huddle (Monthly Knowledge-Sharing Forums)

- **Demos & Discussions** on automation innovations.
- **Peer learning** from successful test automation implementations.
- **Review & update onboarding documentation** for new SDETs.

Refining Test Ownership Models

- Establish **clear ownership** of test suites & automation frameworks.
- Define **best practices for test maintainability & refactoring**.
- Ensure teams **maximize the value of their test suites** by reducing flaky tests.

Next Steps

All SDETs should update their Skills Matrix & submit self-assessments quarterly.
Collaborate with managers to customize career goals based on team needs.
Follow QA/SDET best practices to ensure software delivery aligns with business strategy.
Continue driving AI adoption for smarter test automation & execution.

Stay committed to automation excellence & continuous learning in 2025!